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One USB to rule them all and kill it in the process

All you need to know about the USB Type-C



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In a world where data transfer and management have become not only an asset but also a necessity, a computer or a laptop finds itself surrounded by a sea of wires, be it the charging cable or the USB cables. For people who find themselves using a lot of devices like a printer, a scanner and even a something like a mobile charger or all of them simultaneously, finding a place on their table for even a pen and a notepad is a great achievement. For these people, the introduction of USB Type-C was news to celebrate.



USB Type-C cables are like an answered prayer to those who find it irksome to manage their many vexatious cables. Apple's new MacBook familiarized the world to the slim and new technical standard – the USB Type-C port. This new cable has been designed keeping in mind the future need for speed and efficiency.

Most people confuse USB types with their versions or are unaware of their meaning or significance. USB types define the physical structure of the port while the versions define the characteristics or functioning of the cable. The most commonly used USB types today are Type-A or Type-B USB cables that plug only in one way. Which means that like most computer cables and components, there's only one right way of connecting them. On the other hand, USB Type-C with dimensions of 8.4mm by 2.6mm, has a reversible plug orientation.

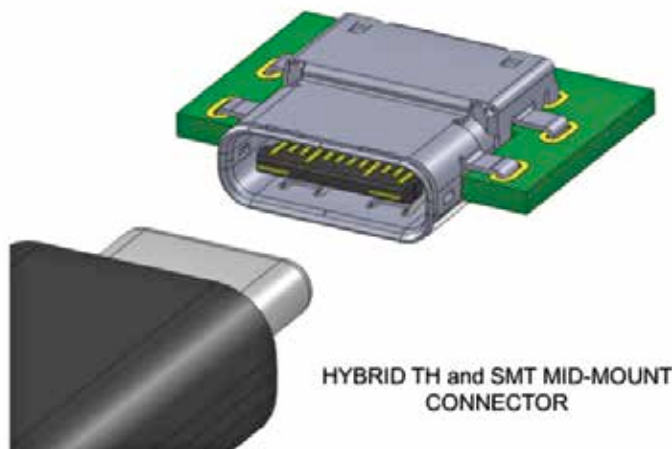
Type C is one third the size of USB Type-A. Its cable has USB Type-C at both ends. Some Type-C cables are said to be active, i.e., they allow host identification and require power levels with the help of a controller chip.

USB Type-C follows the idea similar to that of USB 3.1, for faster speed and USB power delivery for better performance. USB

power delivery increases the power delivery to about 100watts which is ten times more than that of USB 3.0. It has a bandwidth of 10Gbps which is almost double to the bandwidth of USB 3.0. USB Type-C can work under the power current of about 1.5A and 3A under the 5V power bus with the baseline of 900mA.

USB Type-C can connect laptops to mobile phones, to cameras, to keyboards, to printers, scanners and then some more like mobile phones to cameras, or even televisions to laptops and all other new generation devices that have the same port. It's bi-directional in nature which allows us to send and receive power, can be used to charge laptops, by receiving power from the sockets, and mobile phones, by sending power from the laptop, while transferring data at the same time. This solves our problem of limited charge in laptops while travelling and other charging related problems. With this you can charge your laptop in a car using a portable battery charger or a power bank. Also because of its high power delivery, charging will be much easier and faster than what we see today using chargers much smaller than the ones we use today.

But for this cable to act as a charger or work as a connector, the devices that it needs to be connected to must have a USB Type-C port to support the cable. Does that mean that this cable won't be useful for our present day devices that use type A or type B ports? Will we have to buy the new generation devices for



Reference footprint for a USB Type-C Mid-Mount Hybrid receptacle